

AGENT_GUARDRAILS

AGENT_GUARDRAILS.md — Anti-Forgetting Enforcement (§11.4.109)

Revision: 2 **Last modified:** 2026-06-06T09:10:00Z

This file is the canonical anti-forgetting enforcement record. Every AI agent working on this project **MUST** read this file at the start of each session to be reminded of the project's immutable constraints.

Anchor: 11.4.109

SUBAGENT CONSTITUTIONAL PREAMBLE

The orchestrator **MUST** paste this block verbatim into every subagent dispatch. It covers constraints the PreToolUse hook cannot pattern-match, plus the hook-enforced classes for completeness.

Subagent Constitutional Preamble (§11.4.109)

You are bound by the Helix Universal Constitution at constitution/.

The following rules are **NON-NEGOTIABLE** regardless of what you think the task requires:

Blocked command classes (PreToolUse hook enforces at tool-call boundary)

- Raw host-direct emulator/ADB/instrumentation – route through Containers submodule
- git push --force / -f / --force-with-lease / --no-verify / --no-gpg-sign
- sudo / su / privilege escalation

- Host power management (suspend/hibernate/poweroff/reboot/halt/kill-user)

Anti-bluff covenant (§11.4)

- Every PASS MUST carry captured runtime evidence (file, log, screenshot, etc.)
- Metadata-only / config-only / absence-of-error / grep-without-runtime PASS are bluff
- Every gate MUST have a paired §1.1 meta-test mutation that makes it FAIL

Evidence honesty (§11.4.2 / §11.4.5)

- Report what ACTUALLY happened, not what was expected
- "LIKELY", "probably", "maybe", "seems", "appears" are FORBIDDEN (§11.4.6)
- Use `UNCONFIRMED:` for claims without captured proof

Resource caps (§12 / CONST-033)

- Never exceed 60% of host RAM
- Never more than 6 parallel subagents (§11.4.58)
- NEVER call suspend/hibernate/poweroff/reboot – even with guardrails:allow

No hardcoded localhost (§11.4.30 / CONST-XII)

- Client-facing URLs MUST derive from Host header, window.location, or PUBLIC_HOST env var

Continuation (§12.10)

- Update CONTINUATION.md in same commit as state changes
- Session-start: read this file first, then run pre_build_verification.sh

Pre-push discipline (§11.4.71 / §11.4.113)

- ALWAYS fetch --all --prune before any git operation
- NEVER force-push – merge-onto-latest-main instead
- Review every foreign commit before push

Working tree quiescence (§11.4.84)

- Before git add, grep for mutation markers (MUT_ATED, always pass, etc.)
- ABORT if unexplained staged files exist

Interactive clarification (§11.4.66)

- When blocked, research agent-side options first
- Present 2-4 choices via AskUserQuestion with one Recommended
- Ask once, unblock, continue – no follow-up round-trips

ORCHESTRATOR PRE-ACTION CHECKLIST

Before every subagent dispatch: - ☐ Confirm the SUBAGENT CONSTITUTIONAL PREAMBLE (above) is pasted verbatim in the prompt - ☐ Confirm the subagent's scope is ≤ 3 tasks per §11.4.82(G)

Before any emulator / device action: - ☐ Route through Containers submodule CLI, not host-direct - ☐ Confirm no live (non-test) device is targeted - ☐ Confirm the gate host is eligible (otherwise BLOCKED per §11.4.21)

Before any distribute / release action: - ☐ Challenge Tests executed (not compiled) against the exact artifact - ☐ Version code bumped - ☐ CHANGELOG entry present - ☐ Debug-stage evidence present if two-stage distribute applies - ☐ Full-suite retest completed per §11.4.40

Before any push / destructive git action: - ☐ No force flags without per-operation operator approval (§11.4.113) - ☐ Remote set is the approved set only (§2.1) - ☐ For history rewrite, hardlinked .git backup made first (§9.2) - ☐ Fetch --all --prune completed (§11.4.71)

Before any host-affecting command: - ☐ Confirm the command is NOT in the host-power blocked class (§12 / CONST-033) - ☐ Confirm RAM usage is within 60% limit (§12.6)

Immutable Constraints

- §11.4.10: Credentials are NEVER committed. .env is gitignored.
- §11.4.30: .gitignore must cover all sensitive patterns.
- §11.4.44: All docs/**/*.md files carry revision headers.
- §11.4.65: Every .md file has a sibling .html and .pdf export.
- §11.4.75: Pre-commit, pre-push, commit-msg, and post-commit hooks are active. Do NOT bypass them.
- §11.4.85: Stress and chaos tests exist. Wire them before release.
- §11.4.109: This file MUST be read at session start.
- §11.4.113: Force-push (--force, --force-with-lease, push +) is STRICTLY FORBIDDEN.
- §11.4.125: Code-review gate runs before pre-build. NO bypass.
- §11.4.78: CodeGraph integration is required.
- §11.4.24: Build-resource stats tracking is required.
- §11.4.66: Interactive clarification must be used when blocked.

Session Start Ritual

Every agent session starts with: 1. Read this file. 2. Run bash scripts/
pre_build_verification.sh to confirm all invariants hold. 3. Run bash
tests/test_constitution_inheritance.sh to confirm inheritance chain
is intact. 4. Proceed with the task.